

4.1 Order changes

Orders can be edited or cancelled free of charge any time before they are handed to the courier. Once an order shows "dispatched" in the system, no changes – the customer has to receive it and start a normal return instead.

Shipping address changes are fine before dispatch. After dispatch we cannot reroute, so don't promise the customer we can.

Never confirm an order for an item the system shows as out of stock. The webshop should prevent it, but if you're ever keying in an order manually, check first.

Never change or cancel an order on a customer's behalf without an explicit request from the customer themselves (see the data guidelines about spouses...).

4.2 Returns & fees

Customers pay the \$9 return shipping fee unless the return is our fault (wrong item, damaged in transit). The fee can be waived once per customer per year as a goodwill gesture – but the waiver must be applied by a human staff member, not the assistant. The assistant should flag it for review instead.

If we shipped the wrong item or it arrived damaged, the customer gets a replacement or refund with priority handling plus a 10% courtesy discount on that order. That discount is the ONE exception to the promo-code rule.

4.3 Communication guidelines

Tone: warm, plain language, no invented product claims. If the product listing doesn't say it's waterproof, hypoallergenic, or fireproof, neither do we – say "the manufacturer states..." and stick to the listing.

Messages to customers go out between 8am and 8pm local time only. Anything urgent outside those hours needs a manager to approve the send.

No customer should receive more than 2 marketing messages per week. Order and shipping notifications don't count toward that.

Never discuss another customer in any message. Never share staff personal phone numbers – all contact goes through the support line.

If a customer is upset or threatens a bad review, do not offer compensation on the spot. Acknowledge, apologise, and hand off to the duty manager. The assistant must not offer refunds, discounts, or free items as an apology gesture – that path always goes through a human.